



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tupelo Christian Preparatory School

School Website: <https://www.tcps.net/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (<https://austinclassical.org>) exhibits clear alignment with classical Christian education across all six elements. The school's public materials emphasize transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), theological grounding in Scripture, a Trivium-centered curriculum with Latin, logic, and rhetoric, Socratic and memory-based pedagogy, and a deep partnership with parents via a collaborative "co-teacher" model. Evidence for liturgical practices is indirect (e.g., Christian Studies and rhetoric choir) but robust theological integration and Scripture-centered aims more than compensate. Faculty pages describe a joyful, grace-filled ethos and strong teacher–parent collaboration, though an explicit "portrait of a teacher"/"living curriculum" statement is not prominent.

Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

Key highlights - Purpose and Goal: Repeated insistence on cultivating "wisdom and virtue" through contemplation of "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" fits the classical telos and language exactly. - Curriculum: Trivium structure, Latin (through Level IV), formal logic, rhetoric with senior thesis and oral defense, and primary sources/Socratic discussion are explicit and detailed. - Pedagogy: Memorization, recitation, songs (Grammar stage); debate/discussion (Logic stage); Socratic method and rhetoric training (Rhetoric stage) are all specified. - Parents & Community: The collaborative schedule formally makes parents "co-teachers," with weekly plans from faculty and teacher office hours to support the home days.

Note on framework: Keyword matching and category judgements below use the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators from "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School," together with the supplied lexicon organized by the six elements.

Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present in Austin Classical materials: - Transcendentals and moral realism: "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "wisdom," "virtue". - Grounded in theology: "glorify Jesus Christ," emphasis on Scripture, Christian Studies (Doctrine/Exegesis/Hermeneutics/Apologetics & Ethics). - Communal/liturgical notes: Christian context and choir in fine arts; site meets at Great Hills Baptist Church (location), but explicit "daily chapel/liturgy" language not found. - Mapping to Six Elements positive lexicon: - truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom; theology, sacred scripture; Christian formation; apologetics; reverence for theological study. - Negative indicators: none surfaced (no "values-neutral" or "moral relativism" language).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +12 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage (within 3 subcomponents: moral realism, theology, liturgy): ~83% (strong in moral realism and theology; liturgy/chapel not explicit)

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Strong moral realism (truth/goodness/beauty), Scripture-centered instruction, and explicit Christian Studies courses match positive indicators; absence of explicit liturgy keeps coverage shy of 100%

but still clearly classical.

Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present: - “Cultivate wisdom and virtue,” contemplation of “the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”. - “Less about training for a specific, temporal vocation” and emphasis on deep learning and formation (“reflect on texts,” “depth over breadth”). - “Great conversation”. - Minor negative signal: - “Preparing them well for success in college and life” (weak workforce/college-readiness cue; not dominant). - Mapping to Six Elements positive lexicon: - formation, cultivate virtue, human flourishing, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, contemplation/scholé language (implicit via “contemplation” of T-G-B).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +12 / -1 - Percent positive: 92% - Percent coverage: 100%

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Mission and philosophy prioritize the classical telos—wisdom, virtue, transcendental aims—over utilitarian outcomes, with only a very mild college-readiness mention.

Element 3 — School Curriculum

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present: - Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric explicitly explained by stage. - Great Books and primary texts: “great books,” “primary source reading,” “great conversation”. - Classical languages: Latin required through middle school; numerous students reach advanced Latin; Latin I–IV sequence noted. - History: Labeled “History” rather than “Social Studies” (ancient, medieval/renaissance, U.S. in global context). - Senior thesis with oral defense in Rhetoric. - Negative indicators: none (no “STEM-first” or “social studies replaces history” framing; “project” appears only as a capstone activity, not a pedagogy philosophy).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +16 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100%

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Clear Trivium structure, Latin, primary texts, integrated historical scope, and Great Books alignment all match classical curricular hallmarks.

Element 4 — School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present: - Grammar stage uses “memorization, recitation, and songs”. - Logic stage emphasizes “debate and discussion”. - Socratic method is explicitly named; rhetoric formation, imitation of models, and senior thesis defense noted. - Restful/Contemplative signals via “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” and “depth over breadth; reflect on texts”. - Mapping to lexicon: Socratic seminar/dialectic; recitation/chanting/singing; rhetoric/orations; wonder/restfulness (scholé-analogous).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +14 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 95% (all major sub-points present; “scholé” term itself not used, but contemplative/restful signals present)

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: The site documents chanting/recitation, debate/discussion, explicit Socratic method, rhetoric capstone, and contemplative learning aims—all strongly classical.

Element 5 — School Faculty

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present: - Faculty responsibilities emphasize a “joyful, grace-filled environment,” truthfulness, collaboration with co-teaching parents, and mastery-oriented instruction with clear objectives (virtue/character language implicit, mentorship implied). - Missing or light signals: - Limited explicit language about teachers as “mentors,” “models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” “faculty of friends,” or a formal “portrait of a teacher/student” in public pages surveyed. - Negative indicators: none (no “facilitator only” or strictly certification-jargon focus).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +4 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 50% (classical mentoring/modeling language is implicit rather than explicit)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Justification: Ethos and partnership are strong, but an explicit portrait of teacher-as-mentor/model-of-virtue (a common classical hallmark) isn't prominent in the public materials reviewed.

Element 6 — School Parents and Community

Keyword findings from school site - Positive indicators present: - Parents as co-teachers/partners are foundational: “co-laboring with families,” formal Collaborative Schedule with weekly plans and teacher office hours; parents are “integral” to education and character formation. - Parent engagement opportunities (tours, pre-view nights) and ongoing communication implied by the model. - Mapping to lexicon: parent partnership, co-educators, home-school connection, parent formation (supported by recommended classical reading list).

Quantification - Positive vs. Negative keyword hits: +10 / -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100%

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Strong, explicit parent partnership central to model; the collaborative schedule functions as a structured co-teaching partnership, a high-confidence classical marker.

Overall Assessment

- Category ratings:
- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Purpose & Goal — CLASSICAL
- Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school's stated telos, Trivium-anchored curriculum (Latin, logic, rhetoric), Socratic/disputation practices, memory and recitation, senior thesis defense, and parent partnership directly align with classical Christian education. Minor gaps (public articulation of liturgical practices; an explicit “portrait of a teacher”) do not materially alter the overall classical profile.

Data points used (select citations from the crawl)

- Mission/aims and T-G-B emphasis; Trivium/Great Conversation basics.
 - Trivium stages; lower-school memory/recitation/songs; logic debate/discussion; rhetoric production/defense; Latin/logic/rhetoric sequences; senior thesis; Socratic method.
 - Scripture-centered formation; Christian Studies sequence (doctrine, exegesis, apologetics/ethics).
 - Collaborative schedule and parent partnership structures (co-teachers; weekly plans; office hours).
 - Faculty ethos and responsibilities (joyful, grace-filled; close collaboration with parents).
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.